time. But now, pen drives and memory cards ensure that storage options are reusable and as tiny as they can get. The future of flash memory holds tremendous possibility. As with electronics, smaller is always better. Currently the smallest flash memory disk is a SanDisk 128GB measuring just 19nm. With traditional methods of data storage we used to worry about how and where to store the disks, damage that could occur to them and how to dispose of old data. Now the only concern is that we might misplace the drive because it is so small.

Float Glass

Before the advent of Float Glass, flat panels of glass were cut from very large cylinders of blown glass that were cut open and and flattened. In this way, large sheets of glass weren't really possible and besides, the glass made this way was very uneven – distorting view considerably. They were expensive as well. Along came Sir Alastair Pilkington, a British engineer who got the idea of floating molten glass on a bed of low-melting-point

molten alloys, usually Tin. The glass that resulted was flat and of uniform thickness, and so had no weird refraction. The first sheets of float glass were made in the '50s and today most glass is of this kind.

FPGA

Although this may sound like just another geeky acronym to you, the importance of FPGA can't be stressed enough. Invented and patented